boring. Ratan's classmate Bob Lurcott said that he was fun-seeking, like many boys of his age: he was 'inquisitive, fun-loving, challenge-seeking—perhaps all in slight excess'. Another classmate of his ascribed to him a 'very strong pleasant presence' with an 'attractive power of personality' and an upbringing that was 'British/European/Continental', imparting a sense of 'always being in gentlemanly control'.

When his friends shared their memories of Ratan during their fiftieth anniversary reunion at Cornell in 2009, it revealed some interesting facets of his personality. Harry Skilton, a Cornellian who summed up everyone's views on behalf of the Alpha Sigma Phi fraternity, said that Ratan is 'a gentle man, a gentleman, a pleasure to know'. He is not 'one dimensional'. There are different Ratans, he elaborated. They are: the 'take-no-quarters Ratan, there is the intrepid Ratan, there is the mischievous Ratan and then there is the mystical Ratan'.

Most of his fraternity brothers also remember how different the taciturn and shy gentleman could be when he was confronted with a dangerous situation. Once, Ratan's friends Bob Allen and Bruce Herbert, pledges at the Alpha Sigma Phi fraternity, decided to launch a midnight raid on Rockledge, the building where Ratan stayed. They barged in with exploding cherry bomb firecrackers and sprayed the walls with shaving cream. But they were in for a big surprise. The Rockledge boys came charging back, counterattacking. There was a 'monumental scuffle'. And one of those leading the challenge was the agile and determined Ratan. He had learned judo and, being quite adept at it, unleashed his martial arts on the surprised pledges. 'Ratan, who is wiry to begin with and seemed to have some prior experience with martial arts, was everywhere, wrestling down pledges' and helped restore order, says Joe Santamaria, Ratan's batchmate.

Ratan was famous amongst his classmates for his adeptness at the hand-slap game he played with his friends during breaks that they took from 'long hours into the night at Sibley in the drafting rooms', recalls Santamaria. He adds that Ratan had 'incredibly good reflexes and just used to beat the heck out of everybody else'. He was 'unbeatable' and left them with 'sore hands', revealed Handler. Elaborating, he said that it revealed a side of Ratan's personality: 'he made sure he won', he 'never wanted to lose'.

After staying for two years in the fraternity dormitory, Ratan and his close friends moved into a nondescript two-storeyed apartment at 113 West